

Boston Sunday Globe

Serving our community since 1872

NOVEMBER 2, 2025

A status quo for Boston voters

As Wu nears new term, many see few changes

This story was reported by Emma Platoff and Globe correspondents Jade Lozada and Angela Mathew. It was written by Platoff.

When the Boston Public Schools bus showed up late — or not at all — it could throw off the whole day for Lisa Stringfellow and her twins.

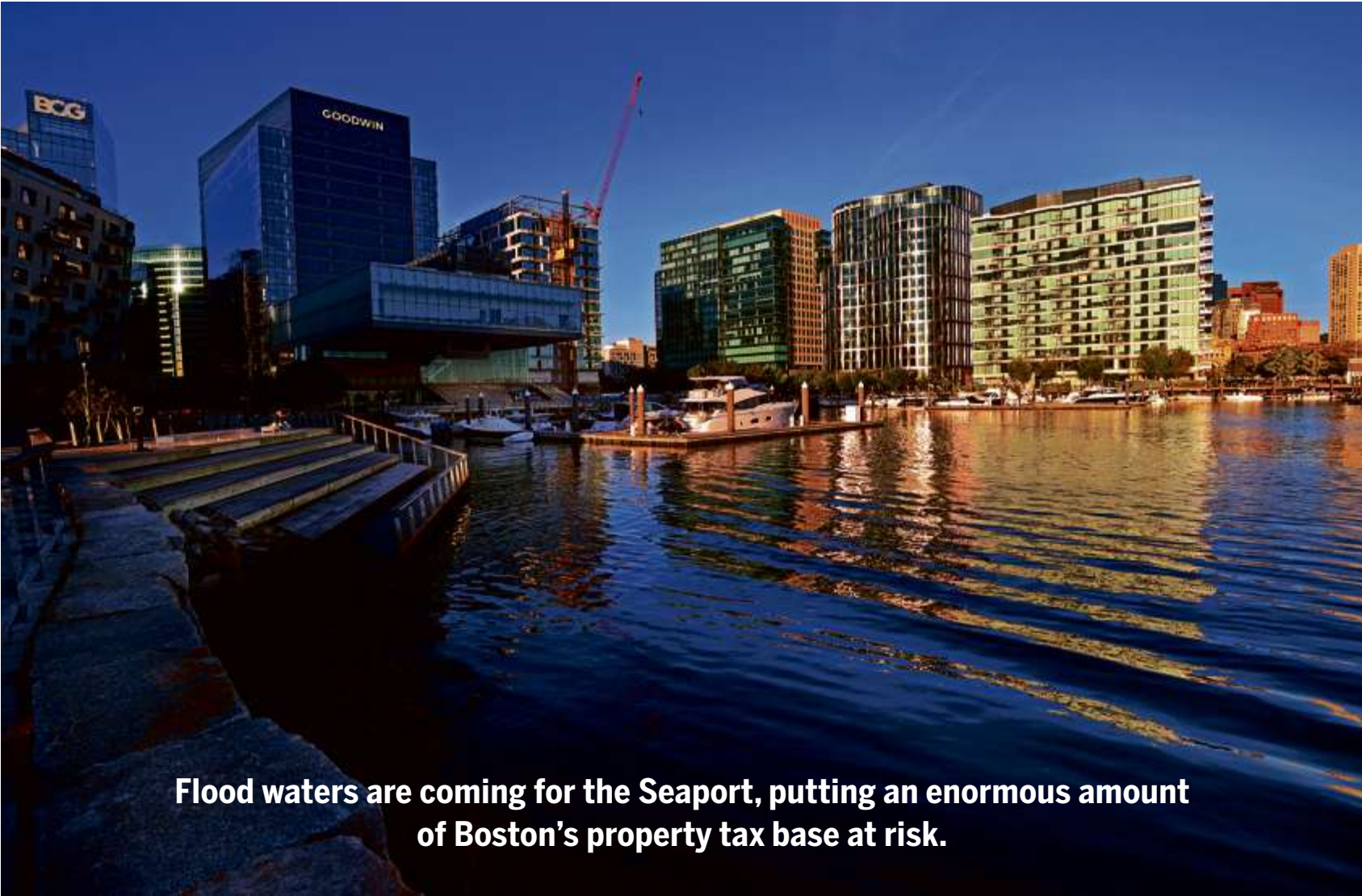
For the 54-year-old Hyde Park mother, it meant driving them to school, making her late for her own job as a teacher. And for her twins, who have disabilities and are now 22, it was a massive disruption to an important routine.

One year, Stringfellow counted up dozens of missed buses. But last year, she remembers just one. Stringfellow told the Globe she has seen a marked improvement in bus pickups during the four years of Mayor Michelle Wu's first term, and she appreciates that she can now track the bus on a new city app.

The system remains imperfect, but the improvements took a weight off her shoulders.

WU, Page B8

WHEN THE FLOODS COME



DAVID L RYAN/ GLOBE STAFF

In all, 99 percent of what's been built in the Seaport in the last quarter-century is at risk of flooding by 2050, according to an analysis.

A swamped Seaport?

Third in a series

By Catherine Carlock and Yoohyun Jung

GLOBE STAFF

Nearly half a century ago, Boston's civic leaders faced a choice.

The city was nearly bankrupt, but the Big Dig and Boston Harbor cleanup promised to transform downtown. Just across Fort Point Channel sat roughly a thousand acres of parking lots and old warehouses on which developers were eager to build.

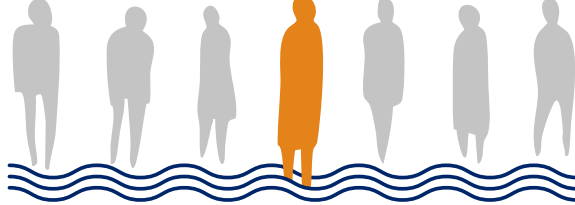
Yes, those parking lots sat on filled-in mud flats just barely above sea level. Even in the 1980s, there were worries about storms and floods and melting ice caps, but the effects seemed far in the future. In the near term, a

small old city that needed tax revenue fast had open land and the will to transform it.

What became the Seaport was born, and it helped usher in a period of unprecedented prosperity for Boston. Today, that thousand acres is home to white-shoe law firms and white-coat-wearing scientists, multimillion-dollar condos with stunning harbor views, beer gardens, and high-end boutiques. Nearly \$20 billion worth of real estate, in all.

Last year, those buildings together generated \$343 million in property taxes for Boston, according to a Globe analysis. That's about 10 percent of the city's tax base, from less than 4 percent of its land. (The estimate does not include residential exemptions for homeowners.)

SEAPORT, Page A10



One of every seven Bostonians

— about 100,000 people — will be exposed to flooding as soon as the 2050s. In downtown, East Boston, South Boston, and the South End, flooding could force about 9,000 people to leave their homes and seek public shelter.

ADOBE STOCK



Daylight Saving Time ended this morning at 2. Make sure to set your clocks back.

What are the top 10 network sitcoms ever? Critic Chris Vognar weighs in. **Sunday Arts, N1.**

Are we misremembering the civil rights movement? **Ideas, K1.**

Super Nov.

Sunday: Full sun, less wind. High 51-56. Low 39-44.

Monday: A few clouds, nice. High 57-62. Low 44-49.

Sunrise: 6:19 Sunset: 4:36

Complete report, C24.

VOL. 308, NO. 125

*

Suggested retail price
\$6.00



This story was reported by Andrew Ryan, Hanna Krueger, Joey Flechas, Steven Porter, and Amanda Milkovits. It was written by Ryan and Krueger and edited by Gordon Russell.

US makes dubious claims in drug raids

Most arrested had no connection to infamous cartel

FRANKLIN, N.H. — President Trump's escalating war against Latin American drug cartels crashed into this leafy old mill town with surprising force one morning in late August, when heavily armed federal agents and local police kicked off a series of raids by tossing a flash-bang grenade and bashing in a door.

The show of force was followed by an announcement from federal authorities that, in coordinated raids across New England, they had seized more

than 500 pounds of drugs and captured nearly 200 members of Mexico's notorious Sinaloa Cartel, the violent syndicate that supplies illegal drugs to the United States.

The special agent in charge of the US Drug Enforcement Administration's New England division, Jarod Forget, said the crackdown "led to 171 cartel member arrests" across the region, including 27 in Franklin. The DEA didn't name any of the suspects, but Forget described them as "high-level ar-



TYLER ALATI, on being described by the DEA as a high-level cartel member

rests" that were part of a national sweep that netted more than 600 operatives of the feared organization over five days.

"We're the DEA," Forget told an interviewer at the time. "We're not going after low-level retail drug traffickers."

Except that isn't true. A Globe Spotlight Team investigation found that many of the DEA's targets in New England were precisely the people Forget said they were not: ad-

CARTEL, Page A12

For Democrats, Calif. maps a path to midterm hopes

By Sam Brodey

GLOBE STAFF

SANTA ROSA, Calif. — Hanging on a wall inside the headquarters of the Sonoma County Democratic Party is a 2-inch button that distills just how the push to redraw the state's congressional districts is bigger than California.

"Fight Fire with Fire — Vote Yes on Prop. 50."

With Proposition 50, a ballot question that will be decided in a statewide election Tuesday, Governor Gavin Newsom and California Democrats are responding to President Trump's unprecedented and successful push for Texas and other Republican-led states to redraw their congressional districts in order to gain seats and block Democrats from recapturing control of the House of Representatives.

Backers of Prop. 50 are asking Californians to temporarily overrule the state's independent redistricting commission — one voters themselves created at the ballot box in 2010 — and

PROP. 50, Page A8

Low Rate. DON'T WAIT!

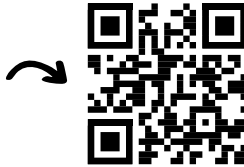
New Purchase Special

5.990% INTEREST RATE | 6.064% APR

30-YEAR FIXED RATE RESIDENTIAL MORTGAGE

Purchase Only • Loans up to \$2 Million • No Points*

Apply online 24/7 at
institutionforsavings.com



INSTITUTION FOR SAVINGS

BUILDING STRONGER COMMUNITIES TOGETHER SINCE 1820.

978-462-3106 • institutionforsavings.com



*APR denotes Annual Percentage Rate as of 10/30/25 and is based on a \$300,000 purchase loan with minimum credit score of 740 and maximum loan-to-value (LTV) of 80%. Rate is subject to change without notice. Unit cost per \$1,000 borrowed is \$5.99. Minimum loan amount is \$100,000, maximum loan amount is \$2 million. Owner-occupied single-family primary residences only. Offer subject to credit approval. Property insurance required. Flood insurance required if the property is located in a FEMA Special Hazard Flood Zone. Monthly payment examples do not include escrow amounts for real estate taxes and/or insurance, if applicable. This may increase payment amount. Other terms and conditions may apply. Member FDIC • Member DIF • NMLS ID. #2478201